

Stop Execution

To stop execution of a MATLAB® command, press **Ctrl+C** or **Ctrl+Break**.

On Apple Macintosh platforms, you also can use **Command+.** (the Command key and the period key).

Ctrl+C does not always stop execution for files that run a long time, or that call built-ins or MEX-files that run a long time. If you experience this problem, include a `drawnow`, `pause`, or `getframe` function in your file, for example, within a large loop. Also, **Ctrl+C** might be less responsive if you start MATLAB with the `-nodesktop` option.



Note

For certain operations, stopping the program might generate errors in the Command Window.

To programmatically stop execution of a function or script before reaching the end, use the `return` function. MATLAB returns control to the Command Window or the invoking function.

See Also

[drawnow](#) | [getframe](#) | [pause](#) | [return](#)

YOU MIGHT ALSO BE INTERESTED IN

